



ganisations who aim, or are already working on, in being an open source player, and what are the business models they can pursue for profits?

"I think the key aspect is to have a business model. But here's the thing, the vast majority of people who are investing in open source are not quite investing directly for the sake of it. I don't think there is something directly attracting them to invest in open source," says Hadi Hariri, VP, Developer Advocacy, JetBrains.

He adds, "They are not investing to make a better world using open source but there are key indicators that force us to use open source, which are good until there is a sustainable business model, which unfortunately many do not have."

Cue: Microsoft's here!

We have all heard and also used Microsoft, and the biggest cue that open source is indeed the future can be derived from what the organisation is doing on the respective open source front. But why is Microsoft in open source?

"Satya (Nadella) was very clear when he took over Microsoft, that it has to be more open than it ever was. This actually goes back to our core thinking of wanting to do more for every person and organisation, which cannot be achieved by being closed," says Sanjeev Sharma.

He adds, "If 40 per cent of CIOs have Linux as one of their prime strategies, and 60 per cent of developers want to see the cloud providers in open source, if 90 per cent of enterprises deploy Linux in some shape and form, I think it indicates an absolutely clear market decision."

Sanjeev mentions that he sees tremendous opportunities to build around open source, affirming that Microsoft is committed to stay open in the future. It is worth mentioning here that 50% of Azure's VM cores are Linux, and 60% of images on

Picking the Right Open Source Business Model

"You can always look at it as either half-glass-full or half-glass-empty. We can leverage a little larger ecosystem, by reaching out to companies all over the world, thus leveraging the public clouds," says **Sanjeev Sharma, Director, New ISV Partnerships, Microsoft**.



"Focus more on the pain of the consumer, and then make a business model that can help you survive. Times are changing rapidly. It's good to be on the dynamic side as these changes will help you survive in the long run," says **Samir Doshi, Co-founder & Director at iNextrix Technologies**.



"It's important to keep figuring out things on the way. It's critical to always remain agile and flexible. Everyone should nurture their curiosity and keep testing waters to see what works best for them. The market is optimistic so why shouldn't you be," says **Kabir Chandhoke, COO, SourceFuse Technologies**.



"If you want to leverage open source, you should rethink your decision. Firstly, whether open source will provide any benefits or not. Once your decision is certain, make sure you have a business model around it. If you want to make it successful, make sure you have a license that is not overly permissive," says **Hadi Hariri, VP, Developer Advocacy, JetBrains**.



it are also Linux based. More than half of the ecosystem on Linux, as Sanjeev confirms, is Linux based. SaaS applications and various other applications are leveraging open source.

He goes on to explain, "This also brings opportunity for any new offering that is coming to the market to continue to leverage their core DNA while also getting exposed to the larger market worldwide, giving an opportunity to experience the full might of larger cloud providers. Talking about India, we have more than 30,000 customers in just one segment."

Solving one problem using open source creates room for solving many other problems. For example, a normal customer service app has to touch different platforms, while being compatible with different types of devices. The same might also have to browse through multiple databases. The idea, as per Sanjeev, is to slowly and steadily multiply what is being offered to clients.

"You begin to try by offering one solution to one type of cus-

tomers base and then you can pivot to a larger market. Today's cloud provides you that opportunity to experiment," he adds.

Another remarkable thing to point out is that Microsoft had acquired GitHub for \$7.5 billion in 2018. The company then, in March 2021, had announced a grant of ten million rupees to fund India's open source contributors working on building software using open source tools.

Subsidise and maximise

Taking example of the likes of Microsoft, Amazon, and Google, along with the open source ecosystem they operate in, it is clear that their open source business model is subsidised by the cloud service they provide/sell. Facebook, as per Hariri, is subsidised by data and advertising. Similarly, there are others who subsidise the business of open source by selling tools, and one example of the same is JetBrains.

"I don't think there are any key parameters. You should look at how you are going to sustain your open